for more experiences, more lives. Life has proved unsatisfactory, so we want more of it in the hope that it will get better. The subjective experiences of discontent, frustration and disappointment happen because we cling to what is by nature impermanent.

Further reading: Collins 1982; Conze 1959; Gethin 1998; Williams 1998

**Dvaita-Vedanta:** a strongly dualistic school expressing a rigorously monotheistic *Vishnu* cult, this tradition was inaugurated in South West India in the thirteenth century by ***Madhva*** in reaction to the ultimately anti-theistic non-dualism of ***Advaita-vedanta*** and as a response to the ***Vishishta-advaita*** of ***Ramanuja*** whose intimate association of God and the essentially dependent soul he regarded as compromising God's transcendent perfection. He departed from the tenets of mainstream ***Vedanta*** by denying that God is both the material and the efficient causes of the world. God creates by organising an independent material principle subject to his governance. Other exponents are the acute logicians *Jayatirtha* (1345–88) and *Vyasatirtha* (1460–1539), both of whom commented on ***Madhva***'s expositions of the ***Upanishads***, ***Bhagavad Gita*** and ***Brahma Sutras***.

*Dvaitins* uphold the existence of a plurality of individual selves and the mind-independence of the physical world, both of which are existentially dependent upon *Vishnu* who is the only truly independent and self-sufficient reality that sustains everything. Devotion (*bhakti*) to the personal deity leads to release from rebirth.

Every entity intrinsically possesses a distinguishing feature (***vishesha***) that identifies it uniquely. We immediately know entities, and ourselves, in their uniqueness without having to compare them with anything else.